

also entered under my roommate's name. I wanted to get my roommate, Will, to enter the contest as well, but he had no interest in trading. So I did a second entry under his name. I traded the two accounts differently to increase my odds of winning. There were 10 winning slots, and I came in sixth, but it was on Will's entry. The sixth place prize was \$3,000. In addition to the cash prizes, the top 10 winners also won a weeklong trip to the Bahamas for themselves and a companion. I told Will, "You have to accept the prize. It's under your name."

Was there an official prize ceremony?

Oh, yeah.

Who went up to get the prize?

Will did. The prize check they gave Will was about this big.

[Woodruff draws a large rectangular shape in the air with his hands.]

The next morning, we went to the local bank to try to cash it. The check wouldn't fit through the teller window.

I don't get it. They gave you an oversized check?

It was a mock check, but we didn't realize it because it looked official. We were hung over, and we were idiots. It just didn't occur to either one of us that the check was just a prop. We received the real check in the mail later.

I felt really guilty that I had played two hands to win the trading contest. On the fifth day, there was a picnic, and I went up to one of the two guys running the event and confessed to him that I had entered twice. "Are you kidding me?" he said. "We wish everyone would enter 10 times. We want people to do multiple accounts and try different strategies. You didn't have to enter under your friend's name."

Did you have any game plan of how you wanted to get into trading?

I quickly figured out that I didn't want to be a broker working for commissions or a money manager working just for management fees. The incentive fee structure appealed to me. I liked the idea of having your pay directly linked to how well you did.